

ENGLISH **LIVE**

32

COMPREHENSION & VOCABULARY

UPSC / BANK PO / SSC / OTHERS

SESSION - 32

10th MARCH, 2017

To Make Every Single Day Women's Day

Democracy remains the key to women's equality

International Women's Day serves to remind us, lost, as we tend to be, in the hurly-burly of daily toil, of a vital goal of equality that has not only not been achieved ever since it was recognised as a vital part of social emancipation but appears as remote today as it was a decade ago. Gender equality should not be the concern of women alone, but of all citizens who want to live in a democratic polity and an equitable society. Sure, this cannot be achieved by dedicating one day to the cause. But that one day should serve to re-examine the work agenda towards equality and rededicate every organisation to this goal.

In India, the next step towards gender justice varies, depending on one's location. In some parts, it is ending female foeticide and getting girls into schools. In some circles, it is progressing to paternity leave. In some religions, it is ending bias rooted in personal law, in others, it is bringing tradition and practice in line with reformed laws. In a place like Nagaland, customary law precludes



women from political leadership, putting it at odds with the basic spirit of the Constitution. Unlike in countries with a relatively more even spread of social development, in India, the relative liberation of working women, especially those in the organised sector, from the drudgery of unpaid, unrecognised domestic work comes at the expense of less fortunate women, who are still redeemed from abject poverty by the menial jobs they perform at other people's homes.

But all women live under the shadow of sexual violence in India, whether actresses, call centre executives working late in the office or returning home at dusk, rural women stepping out to relieve themselves or just about any woman deemed, as per the norms of patriarchal tradition, to be transgressing codes of propriety in terms of dress, place, time or the gender of her companion.

Yes, there are horrid acid attacks by spurned men, but there are also women who increasingly break the glass ceiling or fight back against sexual harassment at the workplace. Stronger democracy is what all women need, along with men.

THE ECONOMIC TIMES

8th March, 2017

←
DISCUSSION ON
10th March (Today)

→
DISCUSSION ON
13th March (Monday)

SOLAR ENERGY

Now to Catch the Sun



Ashok Jhunjhunwala & Bhaskar Ramamurthi

The recent tenders for setting up and operating solar and wind power generation firms show that the price of renewable power is now approaching that from greenfield coal-based power plants in India. It will not take too long for solar photovoltaics to become the cheapest source of power.

But solar power is generated only during the day, that too intermittently. Similarly, wind power is generated during certain months and the power output also varies. If energy storage was inexpensive, one could have dealt with this intermittency by storing excess energy generated to be used when needed. Since grid-connected energy storage continues to be very expensive, generated power needs to be consumed instantly.

As the consumer demand for power also varies with time-of-day and season, there is a problem of matching demand to supply, both of which vary independently. One option would be to have excess capacity and get the non-renewable power generators, which are under our control, to back off when needed. However, this strategy has to be adopted judiciously, as it will increase the cost of non-renewable power.

Demand management, where the customer is incentivised to use more power when available and consume less when there is a shortage, will help and will, indeed, become necessary. Smart buildings and factories will take us towards implementation of demand management in time.

But what would really enable renew-

able power to become an unfettered dominant supplier is some kind of large-scale storage. The electric vehicle (EV) is precisely such an application, where the cost of energy per km, including the cost of its storage, has to be only lower than the corresponding cost of a petroleum-based vehicle, to be economically viable.

EVs use distributed storage. Growth of renewable energy in India, thus, has an EV compulsion, as it requires EVs to grow in the country and provide the first large-scale storage that the growth in renewables needs. In energy terms, if all vehicles in India were electric today, they would use up 15-20% of India's electricity generated.

If their batteries are charged intelligently, EVs could help overcome the intermittent nature of renewable power generation. But are EVs in themselves economically viable in India today?

The EV needs batteries to store energy needed for its operation. As battery prices fall steadily and the efficiency of motors grows to deliver higher mileage per unit of energy, there is a crossover point when EVs with sufficient range per battery charge become a more cost-effective option than diesel, petrol or CNG based vehicles. Left to itself, it may take three to five years for prices to fall enough in international markets for EVs configured for use abroad to emerge as a better alternative for



The glasses are half full...

consumers in India.

This, however, implies that India would be importing EV subsystems from the start, and it will be difficult to establish any kind of technology leadership. We may later see local manufacturing of at least some of the subsystems. Nevertheless, there is the real possibility that the value of imports of EVs and EV subsystems will match the oil import bill today and leave us no better off than today.

But there is another option towards large-scale EV adoption. The key elements of EV technology are available today at the right prices for several types of vehicles widely used in the Indian market. With an innovative, coordinated and market-oriented effort by industry and the government, certain EVs can be produced in India today. Adoption can be rolled out rapidly in a fully market-driven manner.

In these specific segments, India could attain a globally competitive leadership position in three to five years. This effort will simultaneously encourage local intellectual property (IP) generation and the manufacture of most EV subsystems or substantial parts of them. India can move towards substitution of oil imports with locally produced energy and EVs including subsystems.

Apart from these intrinsic benefits of early adoption of EVs, it forces the simultaneous growth of renewable energy production in India. This slew of reasons should drive us to single-mindedly pursue immediate efforts in a mission mode to enable early adoption of EVs in India.

A laissez-faire attitude will negatively impact the indigenous manufacturing of India's future automobiles and subsystems as well as India's import bill. It will also slow down the integration of renewable energy sources into the grid at scale.

Jhunjhunwala is adviser, minister of power, coal, new and renewable energy, and Ramamurthi is director, IIT Madras

THE ECONOMIC TIMES

7th March, 2017

To Make Every Single Day Women's Day

Democracy remains the key to women's equality

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To Make Every Single Day Women's Day

THE ECONOMIC TIMES

8th March, 2017

To Make Every Single Day Women's Day

- **Democracy** remains the key to women's **equality**
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LIVE

To Make Every Single Day Women's Day

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8th March 2017



LEARNING / SPACE

...Transforming Human Lives

Democracy remains the key to women's **equality**



LEARNING / SPACE

...Transforming Human Lives

Democracy

*USA is one among the oldest democracies and India is the largest **democracy** in the world.*



Democracy

It is the belief in freedom and equality among the people, and the power is either held by elected representatives or directly by the people themselves

Equality

*The ideals of democracy involve economic **equality** and social **equality**.*



Equality

The right of different groups of people to enjoy similar position and same treatment

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...Transforming Human Lives

International Women's Day serves to **remind** us, lost, as we tend to be, in the **hurly-burly** of daily **toil**, of a *vital* goal of equality that has not only not been achieved ever since it was recognised as a vital part of social *emancipation* but appears as *remote* today as it was a decade ago.

Remind

*One should **remind** me about the marriage function just a day in advance as I may likely to forget because of hurly-burly of my daily chores.*



Remind

Making someone think of something they have forgotten or might have forgotten

Hurly-burly

*Most of the citizens visit Ramakrishna beach in Visakhapatnam during the weekends so as to get away from the **hurly-burly** of everyday life.*



Hurly-burly

Busy / noisy situation

Toil

*In India, students prepare for competitive examinations by **toiling** hard throughout the night.*



Toil

Work extremely hard / incessantly

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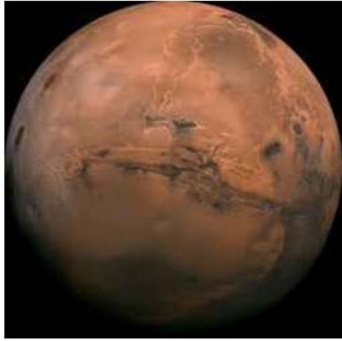


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Vital



Scientists are exploring the possibility of human life on Mars and probing the existence of liquid water, which is **vital** for human survival



Vitamins and minerals are **vital** for healthy living and one should take balanced diet

Vital

Extremely important, necessary for success or continued existence of something

Emancipation

*The real challenge for Indian democracy is the **emancipation** of millions of people from Below Poverty Line (BPL).*



Emancipation

The process of being set free from legal, social, or political restrictions.

Remote



*The living conditions in **remote** parts of the country are the real cause of concern for the rural as they are devoid of basic education and health facilities*

Remote

Remote

*Achieving gender parity appears to be a **remote** possibility in our country.*



Remote

Distant in time

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Gender equality

*Economic researchers say that we could reach **gender equality** in the boardrooms of major corporations within the next 7 years.*

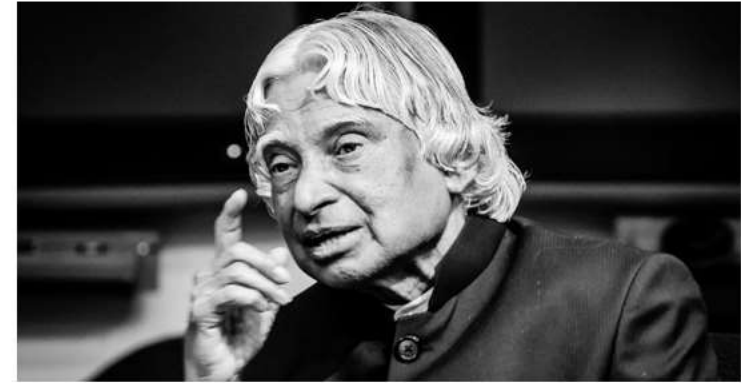


Gender equality

The state in which access to rights or opportunities is unaffected by gender.

Dedicate

One should **dedicate** himself / herself to achieve a particular purpose in life.



Dedicate

Devote time or effort to a particular task with an aim of achieving this

Foeticide

*The preference for sons is still strong in India, that's why female **foeticide** is still taking place in several parts of the country.*



Foeticide

The crime of killing a baby that has not yet been born

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In some circles, it is progressing to **paternity leave**. In some religions, it is ending **bias rooted** in personal law, in others, it is bringing **tradition** and practice in line with reformed laws.



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Paternity leave

*My wife is expected to deliver a baby in October and I would love to take **paternity leave**.*



Paternity leave

It is the time, a father takes off work at the birth or adoption of a child

Bias

*In our country, some of the decisions of the government will have cast / religious **bias***



Bias

The action of supporting or opposing a person or think in unfair way

Root



Root



- Money is the **root** cause of all the evils.
- Jealousy is one of the **root** causes for not making much progress in several fields in our country after independence.

The basic cause, source, or origin of something.

Tradition

*India has a long **tradition** of religious beliefs.*



Tradition

A belief or a principle / way of acting that people in a particular society or group

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In a place like Nagaland, **customary law precludes** women from political leadership, putting it **at odds** with the basic spirit of the Constitution.



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ARTICLE 243T

Not less than one-third of the total number of seats to be filled by direct election in every municipality must be reserved for women by rotation.

ARTICLE 371(A)

No Act of Parliament in respect of

- i. Religious or social practices of the Nagas.
- ii. **Naga Customary Law and Procedure.**
- iii. Administration of Civil and Criminal Justice, involving decisions according to Naga Customary Law.
- iv. Ownership and transfer of land and its resources shall apply to the state of Nagaland unless the Legislative Assembly of Nagaland by a resolution, so decides

It appears that Constitution needs to be amended to make the things explicit!

Preclude

*Lack of digital literacy
precludes effective
implementation of digital
transactions across the
country.*



Preclude

Preventing someone from doing something / to make something impossible

Preclude

*It has been raining since yesterday, but that doesn't **preclude** the possibility that the skies will clear by this evening.*



Preclude

Preventing someone from doing something / to make something impossible

At odds

*The employee is quite arrogant and his behavior is **at odds** with the interest of the company.*



At odds

In conflict or at variance

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Relative

*There are several drugs available to treat this disease, but the **relative** effectiveness of this particular drug is not known.*



Relative

It is considered in relation or in proportion to something else.

Drudgery

In India, several unfortunate women are engaged in domestic drudgery.



Drudgery

Hard menial or dull work.

Redeem

*The declaration of the ceasefire as well as coming together of Russia and Turkey has **redeemed** Syrian civil war to some extent.*



Redeem

Compensate for the faults or bad aspects of

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Abject

*In Sub-Saharan Africa,
millions of people are still
living in **abject** poverty.*



Abject

Something bad experience and up to the maximum degree.

Poverty



Poverty

DIMENSIONS OF POVERTY

- 1 Poverty means hunger and lack of shelter
- 2 It is the situation, parents are not able to send their children to school
- 3 It is the situation, where the sick people cannot afford medical treatments
- 4 It is also the situation, which exists due to lack of clean water and sanitation facilities

It is one of the biggest challenges of independent India and at present 20% of people are below the poverty line.

Menial

*Several students in America take up **menial** jobs like cleaning the table, cleaning the floor in restaurants, etc., to help see them through university education.*



Menial

Do not require skill and low in social strata and paid normally less

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Shadow



Shadow

Several women live under the *shadow* of sexual violence in India.



Shadow

With reference to ominous oppressiveness, or sadness and gloom

Dawn



*The first light at **dawn** at several beaches in our country is extremely beautiful.*

Dawn

The first appearance of light in the sky before sunrise.

*As **dusk** fell, many gathered for a religious prayer on the beach.*



Dusk

The darker stage of twilight.

Patriarchal

*India is basically a
patriarchal society.*



Patriarchal

Society or government controlled by men.

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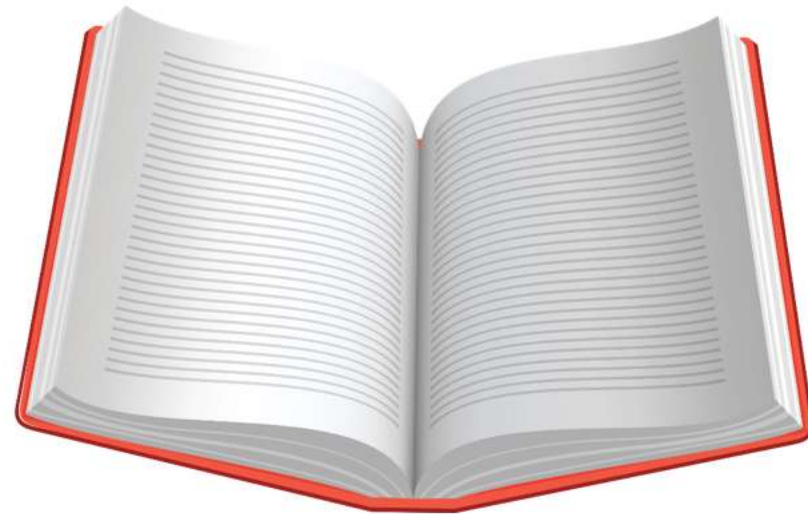
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Transgress

*The novel written by
xxx **transgressed** the
limits of decency.*



Transgress

*Go beyond the limits of what is accepted morally, socially, or
legally*

Propriety

*Normally in our country, women live under stringent codes of **propriety** set by the patriarchal society.*



Propriety

Conformity to conventionally accepted standards of behaviour or morals.

Companion

*For visiting tourist places, one should have a good **companion**.*



Companion

A person or animal with whom one spends a lot of time or with whom one travels.

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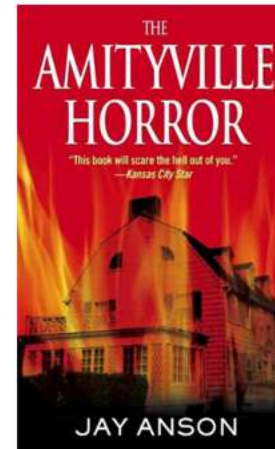
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Horror

*I was more interested in
horror stories during my
childhood.*



Horror

An intense feeling of fear, shock, or disgust

Spurn

*By **spurning** the invitation by the government to discuss the matter, the trade union leaders have lost an opportunity to find an answer to their grievances.*



Spurn

To refuse to accept something or someone because you feel that thing or person is not worth having

Glass ceiling

*Kiran Bedi is a quintessential example of removing the **glass ceiling** for women in comparison to men in police.*



Glass ceiling

An unacknowledged barrier to advancement in a profession, especially affecting women and members of minorities

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FILE PHOTO

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